ACC250: Introduction to Financial Accounting (2026 Fall)

Jaeyoon Yu, Ph.D. — yu10j@cmich.edu

Best Way to Reach Me:	Email
Office Hours:	Grawn 328 | MW 11:45 – 12:30
	Virtual (Link) | F 09:00–10:30 (e-mail me if it doesn't work.)
Lecture Room & Hours:	Grawn 301| MW 12:30 – 13:45 (22478925)
	MW 14:00 – 15:15 (22478923)
	MW 15:30 – 16:45 (22478922)
Lecture Period:	8/31/26 – 12/12/26 (Exam week: 12/14 – 12/18)
Course Format:	In-person classroom
Absence/Tardiness:	**Google form [click here]** | submit **in advance**
Late Submission:	**Google form [click here]** | submit **before the deadline**
Missing an Exam:	**Google form [click here]** | submit **as soon as possible**

Contents

1 Communication **2**

2 Expectations **2**

3 Course Rules/Etiquettes **2**

4 Course Description & Learning Objectives **2**

5 Course Materials **3**

6 Grading **3**
- 6.1 Attendance & Participation . . . 3
- 6.2 Homework Assignments . . . 4
- 6.3 Exams . . . 4

7 Course Schedule (Tentative) **5**

8 Other Information **6**
- 8.1 Extra Credits . . . 6
- 8.2 Presentation . . . 6
- 8.3 Inclusive Access Program . . . 6
- 8.4 Financial Statement Data Sources . . . 6
- 8.5 Academic Integrity Policy . . . 6
- 8.6 Disability Accommodation . . . 6

1 Communication

- The best way to reach me is via **email**, especially if you have an urgent issue.
- Include **course code**, **starting time** of your section, and the **key matter** in the **email subject** line.
  - Example of a good subject line: **"ACC250 | 14:00 | Questions about Revenue Recognition"**
- Use **professional language** in all communications.
- Allow **48 hours** for email responses during business days.
- Keep in mind normal working hours (09:00 – 17:00, Monday through Friday).
- Use the **Google form [click here]** for **attendance matters** (incl. absence, tardiness, and leaving early).
- Use the **Google form [click here]** for **late submission**.
- Use the **Google form [click here]** if you **cannot take an exam**.

2 Expectations

You are expected to:

- attend all classes and participate in class discussions.
- read each chapter of the textbook before we begin it in class.
- complete all assignments.
- take all exams.

I may **cold-call** you during class, so come prepared.

3 Course Rules/Etiquettes

Please adhere to the following as a courtesy to both your fellow students and the instructor:

1. **Integrity.** Work you submit must be the product of your own efforts. This includes **dishonesty involving the use of AI**. Cheating results in a grade of **F** for the course.
2. **Presence.** **Remain in attendance** for the duration of class, except in an emergency. Inform your instructor **ahead of time** if you must **leave early**.
3. **Focus.** Treat this course as a professional engagement: **no private conversations or messaging** during class.
4. **Devices.** Use technology only for **course-related** activity. Your **screen is visible to your neighbors**, and off-task use — social media, streaming, or homework for this and other classes — decreases **both your learning and theirs**.

Violations of course etiquette will have substantial consequences (e.g., participation score, grade adjustments), and the instructor decides on their severity.

Use of IT devices in Class

- **You are not allowed** to use your laptop, smartphone, or other IT devices during class hours. **Handouts are provided**, so you do not need them for note-taking. Engaging in **any non-course-related activity** — including **homework for this course** — is not allowed.
- Use your IT devices **only when**:
  - I **instruct you** to do so for an in-class activity (e.g., **Google Forms**, **Socrative**); or
  - you have my **permission in advance** for a course-related purpose.
- You are expected to **bring your own laptop**, but only for the cases above.
- **Violation of this policy may result in a failing grade (F) for the course.**

The full **Academic Integrity Policy** is in Section 8.5.

4 Course Description & Learning Objectives

This course mainly covers **1) balance sheet and 2) income statement**, the two of four financial statements public companies need to prepare periodically. Two other financial statements — **3) statement of shareholders' equity and 4) cash flow statements** — are covered briefly.

Ch	Title
Part 1 (Ch1–4): Financial Statements Overview	
1	Business decisions and financial accounting
2	The Balance Sheet
3	The Income Statement
4	Adjustments and financial statements
Part 2 (Ch6–8): Operating Activities	
6	Merchandising operations
7	Inventory and cost of goods sold
8	Receivables and bad debt expense
Part 3 (Ch9–11): Investing & Financing Activities	
9	Long-lived tangible assets
10	Liabilities
11	Stockholders' equity

At the end of the course, students are expected to:

1. Understand basic financial accounting principles
   - Revenue recognition
   - Matching principle (for expense)
   - Cost principle (for assets)
2. Understand the elements of the four financial statements.
3. Describe the relationship between four financial statements.
4. Analyze **financial statements of public firms** (see Section 8.4).
5. Conduct basic financial ratio analysis.

5 Course Materials

1. **Lecture slides**
2. **Fundamentals of Financial Accounting** by Phillips et al., 8th Edition[1]
3. All course content is housed in our course shell on Blackboard.

6 Grading

Component	Percentage
Attendance & Participation	15%
Homework Assignments	25%
Exam 1	15%
Exam 2	20%
Exam 3 (Final)	25%
Total	**100%**

F	D-	D	D+	C-	C	C+	B-	B	B+	A-	A
00–60	60–64	64–67	67–70	70–74	74–77	77–80	80–84	84–87	87–90	90–94	94–100

6.1 Attendance & Participation

- **Attendance is mandatory**. It is checked through two things: whether you **actually came to the session**, and your **participation in Socrative-based activities**. If you do not participate, you are **marked absent** for that session.[2]
- Attendance is checked randomly, 10+ times in total.
  - A **designated seat** will be assigned for attendance checks.
  - The seat you choose in the **first session after Week 1** will be your designated seat for the semester.

[1] This course uses the **Inclusive Access** program — see Section 8.3.

[2] Missing a single activity does not make you absent — if a session has three activities and you miss one, that is not an absence. As long as you are actually there and participate at a reasonable level, you are fine.

  - Seats at the back of the classroom will be blocked.
- You will receive **full credit** if you (1) **attend all sessions**; (2) **participate in in-class activities** (e.g., Socrative-based interactions); and (3) **follow this course guideline**, especially the **course etiquettes** (Section 3) and **academic integrity** (Section 8.5).
- **Extra participation** beyond the above will be considered as **extra credit**.

Absence & Tardiness

- If you want an absence or tardiness **excused**, complete this **Google form [click here] in advance**, then provide **written documentation** (e.g., doctor's note). You **do not have to email me** separately, as I monitor the form responses.
- All absences without written documentation will be considered **unexcused**.

Accommodation for Absences

To accommodate unexpected situations, **up to two undocumented absences** may be treated as excused if you follow the **course guidelines and etiquettes** and **actively participate** throughout the semester. If you do not need an excuse, there is **no need to submit the form** — the absence simply counts as one of these two.

6.2 Homework Assignments

- All assignments are **equally important** and will be averaged.
- Due dates are always on **Sunday**.
- Four types of assignments:
  1. Reading: You are expected to read the **entire chapter** before we begin it in class. This is **not graded** on its own.
  2. SmartBook: Your reading is checked through the **SmartBook** assignment via **CONNECT**.
  3. Practice Problems: Problem-solving assignments for each chapter.
  4. Others: The **Resume Workshop** and the **Accounting Cycle Project**, to be announced on **Blackboard**.

Submitting Your Assignments

You must click **"Submit"** to turn in an assignment. Work left unsubmitted — even if you answered every question — **will not be graded**, and **no exception will be made**. Always confirm that your submission is recorded before the deadline. I deliberately do **not** turn on **automatic submission**, because doing so would close off the **late submission** option below.

Late Submission for Assignments

- If you have a valid reason with a written evidence (doctor's note, etc.), your late submission can be executed. To do so, you need to submit a **late submission form** before the deadline.
- Otherwise, late assignments will be accepted with a **one-time 20% penalty**, and only **up to one week** after the deadline. You do **not need to get my permission** for this.

Accommodation for Assignments

To accommodate unexpected absences or circumstances, your **two lowest assignment scores will be dropped** if you follow the **course guidelines and etiquettes** and **actively participate** throughout the semester.

6.3 Exams

- Three exams take place in the classroom during class time.
- A calculator is allowed. **Notes are not allowed.**

Exam	Chapters covered
Exam 1	1, 2, 3
Exam 2	4, 6, 7 + 3
Exam 3	8, 9, 10, 11 + 4

Missing an Exam

If you cannot take an exam for a legitimate reason, submit the **Google form [click here] as soon as possible** — and **definitely no later than three days before the exam**, unless a genuine emergency makes that impossible. Attach **supporting documentation** (e.g., doctor's note). You **do not have to email me** separately, as I monitor the form responses. If you **miss any exam without such advance notice**, you are **not able to pass this course**.

7 Course Schedule (Tentative)

Week	Monday		Wednesday		Others
1	08/31	1-1. Introduction	09/02	1-2. Ch0	
2	09/07	No Class (Labor Day)	09/09	1-3. Ch1	
3	09/14	1-4. Ch1, Ch2	09/16	1-5. Ch2	**Resume Workshop (09/15)**
4	09/21	1-6. Ch3	09/23	1-7. Ch3	
5	09/28	1-8. Ch3	09/30	1-9. **Review**	
6	10/05	**Exam**	10/07	2-1. Ch4	
7	10/12	No Class (Fall Break)	10/14	2-2. Ch4	
8	10/19	2-3. Ch4	10/21	2-4. Ch6	
9	10/26	2-5. Ch6	10/28	2-6. Ch7	
10	11/02	2-7. Ch7	11/04	2-8. **Review**	
11	11/09	**Exam**	11/11	3-1. Ch8	
12	11/16	3-2. Ch8	11/18	3-3. Ch9	
13	11/23	3-4. Ch9	11/25	3-5. Ch9, Ch10	
14	11/30	3-6. Ch10	12/02	3-7. Ch10	
15	12/07	3-8. Ch11	12/09	3-9. Ch11 & **Review**	
Exam week: 12/14 – 12/18 (final exam — see below)					

Final Exam		
Your Section	**Date**	**Starts at**
MW 12:30 – 13:45	Monday, 12/14	12:00
MW 14:00 – 15:15	Monday, 12/14	14:00
MW 15:30 – 16:45	Wednesday, 12/16	14:00

Click here for the final exam schedule.

8 Other Information

8.1 Extra Credits

- Given only to those who **attend the session** and **follow the course guidelines**; **no make-up**.
- I take extra credit into account when **determining your final grade** at the end of the semester. This adjustment is **entirely at my discretion**.
- Good examples of what earns extra credit:
  1. **Active in-class participation**.
  2. **Spotting errors in the lecture notes** (so pay attention!).
  3. **Helping your peers understand** the material in class.
  4. **Pop-up quizzes** (if any).

8.2 Presentation

This is a great opportunity to go deeper into a case that is relevant to accounting and to business in general. If you are **genuinely interested** in any of the topics below, please let me know. Each case includes a **link as a starting point** — dig into the material yourself from there. Presentations are **5–7 minutes** and take place on **Wednesday**: explain the **core concept**, then illustrate it using the listed company — or **another company** of your choice. Contact me **at least one week before** the week of the topic you want. Slots are **first-come, first-served**, and the up-to-date schedule is managed on **Blackboard**.

#	Week	Date	Topic	Company
1	2	09/09	Initial Public Offerings	SpaceX **WSJ1**
2	3	09/16	Current Ratio	**Crocs** vs. **Deckers Outdoor**
3	4	09/23	Remaining Performance Obligation	Oracle Corp. **WSJ1**
4	5	09/30	Net Profit Margin	**Costco** vs. **Walmart**
5	7	10/14	Change in Depreciation Schedule	Big tech firms **WSJ1**, **WSJ2**
6	14	12/02	Earnings Per Share and Price-to-Earnings Ratio	**Crocs** vs. **Deckers Outdoor**

8.3 Inclusive Access Program

The Inclusive Access program is used for this course (CONNECT registration link).

- Your CMU account is **charged automatically**, and you have access on the **first day of class**. The CMU Bookstore will email you about the billing process.
- You may **opt out**, but CONNECT is needed for homework and quizzes — if you opt out, you must **purchase access on your own**.

8.4 Financial Statement Data Sources

Financial statement data can be obtained from the following websites:

SEC EDGAR	Wall Street Journal (WSJ)[3]	Financial Times (FT)	Yahoo Finance
CNBC	Finviz	Barchart	Stock Analysis

8.5 Academic Integrity Policy

Work you submit must be the product of your own efforts. Plagiarism, cheating, and other forms of academic dishonesty — including **dishonesty involving the use of AI** — are prohibited.

Penalty: Any student found cheating in this course will receive a grade of **F** for the course, and the incident will be reported to the Office of Student Conduct. The full policy is available in the CMU Bulletin.

8.6 Disability Accommodation

CMU provides students with disabilities reasonable accommodation to participate in educational programs, activities, or services. If you require accommodation, first register with **Student Disability Services** (120 Park Library; telephone 774-3018; TDD 774-2568), then contact me as soon as possible.

[3] Access the WSJ **for free** through **CMU Libraries**.